

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 15

Group 15 Vocabulary

1. Alienate

Meaning: To make someone feel isolated, unwanted, or unfriendly.

Tip to remember: Alienate sounds like “alien.” If you alienate someone, you make them feel like an alien or outsider.

Sentence: His rude behavior alienated many of his friends.

2. Apathy

Meaning: Lack of interest, emotion, or concern.

Tip to remember: “A” means without, and “pathy” relates to feeling. Apathy means without feeling.

Sentence: Student apathy toward politics worried the teacher.

3. Apropos

Meaning: Relevant or appropriate to the situation.

Tip to remember: Apropos sounds like “appropriate.” If something is apropos, it fits the topic.

Sentence: His comment about solar energy was apropos to the discussion on renewables.

4. Apt

Meaning: Suitable, appropriate, or likely to do something.

Tip to remember: Apt sounds like “appropriate.” An apt example is a suitable example.

Sentence: Her comparison between the brain and a computer was apt.

5. Cloak

Meaning: To hide or cover something.

Tip to remember: A cloak covers the body. As a verb, cloak means to cover or hide the truth.

Sentence: The company tried to cloak its financial problems.

6. Consensus

Meaning: General agreement among a group.

Tip to remember: Think of “common sense” among many people. Consensus means shared agreement.

Sentence: The committee reached a consensus after a long discussion.

7. **Distort**
Meaning: To twist, misrepresent, or change the true shape or meaning of something.
Tip to remember: Think of a distorted mirror that twists your face. Distort means to twist reality.
Sentence: The article distorted the facts to support its argument.
8. **Divergent**
Meaning: Moving in different directions; different from each other.
Tip to remember: Divergent comes from diverge, meaning to separate. Divergent ideas move apart.
Sentence: The two researchers had divergent views on the problem.
9. **Elated**
Meaning: Extremely happy and excited.
Tip to remember: Elated sounds like “elevated.” When you are elated, your mood is lifted high.
Sentence: She was elated after receiving the scholarship.
10. **Enchant**
Meaning: To charm, delight, or deeply attract.
Tip to remember: Enchant sounds like magic chants. If something enchants you, it feels magical.
Sentence: The beauty of the mountains enchanted the visitors.
11. **Entrenched**
Meaning: Firmly established and difficult to change.
Tip to remember: Think of soldiers hidden deep in trenches. They are hard to remove. Entrenched ideas are also hard to remove.
Sentence: Corruption had become entrenched in the system.
12. **Exotic**
Meaning: Unusual, foreign, or strikingly different.
Tip to remember: Think of something from a faraway place that feels new and different. That is exotic.
Sentence: The restaurant served exotic dishes from different countries.
13. **Exploitative**
Meaning: Taking unfair advantage of someone or something.
Tip to remember: Exploitative comes from exploit, meaning to use. It means using someone unfairly for benefit.
Sentence: The factory was criticized for its exploitative labor practices.
14. **Foreseeable**
Meaning: Able to be predicted or expected.
Tip to remember: “Fore” means before, and “see” means see. Foreseeable means you can see it before it happens.
Sentence: The accident was foreseeable because the equipment was already damaged.

15. **Forsake**
Meaning: To abandon, leave, or give up something.
Tip to remember: Forsake sounds like “for the sake, leave it.” To forsake something is to leave it behind.
Sentence: He refused to forsake his dream of becoming a researcher.
16. **Gratify**
Meaning: To please or satisfy.
Tip to remember: Gratify sounds like gratitude. When someone gratifies you, you feel thankful and satisfied.
Sentence: It gratified the teacher to see her students succeed.
17. **Heed**
Meaning: To pay attention to advice, warning, or instruction.
Tip to remember: Heed sounds like “hear.” To heed advice means to hear it carefully and follow it.
Sentence: Students should heed the examiner’s instructions.
18. **Judicious**
Meaning: Wise, sensible, and showing good judgment.
Tip to remember: Judicious sounds like judge. A good judge makes wise decisions.
Sentence: A judicious use of time can improve GRE preparation.
19. **Lucid**
Meaning: Clear and easy to understand.
Tip to remember: Lucid sounds like light. A lucid explanation brings light to a confusing topic.
Sentence: The professor gave a lucid explanation of the theorem.
20. **Pertinent**
Meaning: Relevant and related to the matter being discussed.
Tip to remember: Pertinent sounds like “pertaining to.” If something pertains to the topic, it is pertinent.
Sentence: Please include only pertinent details in your answer.
21. **Propriety**
Meaning: Proper behavior; correctness according to social rules.
Tip to remember: Propriety comes from proper. It means behaving properly.
Sentence: The formal event required a sense of propriety.
22. **Scintillating**
Meaning: Brilliant, lively, or sparkling.
Tip to remember: Think of stars scintillating in the sky. Scintillating ideas sparkle intellectually.
Sentence: She gave a scintillating presentation on renewable energy.
23. **Sensational**
Meaning: Very exciting or shocking; sometimes exaggerated to attract attention.

Tip to remember: Sensational news strongly affects your senses and emotions.
Sentence: The newspaper published a sensational story about the scandal.

24. **Sophisticated**

Meaning: Advanced, complex, refined, or cultured.

Tip to remember: Think of a sophisticated machine with advanced technology and refined design.

Sentence: The researchers used a sophisticated model for load forecasting.

25. **Strife**

Meaning: Conflict, struggle, or bitter disagreement.

Tip to remember: Strife sounds like “struggle in life.” It means conflict or trouble.

Sentence: Political strife delayed the development project.

26. **Understated**

Meaning: Presented in a subtle, modest, or restrained way.

Tip to remember: Understated means not overstated; it is calm and not flashy.

Sentence: Her speech was understated but powerful.

27. **Unscrupulous**

Meaning: Dishonest and not guided by moral principles.

Tip to remember: Scrupulous means morally careful. Unscrupulous means not morally careful.

Sentence: Unscrupulous agents cheated many students.

28. **Veracity**

Meaning: Truthfulness or accuracy.

Tip to remember: “Ver” means truth, as in verify. Veracity means truthfulness.

Sentence: The journalist checked the veracity of the claim before publishing it.

29. **Virulent**

Meaning: Extremely harmful, poisonous, or bitterly hostile.

Tip to remember: Virulent sounds like virus. A virulent disease or comment spreads harm.

Sentence: The leader faced virulent criticism after the decision.

30. **Volatile**

Meaning: Unstable and likely to change suddenly; easily angered or explosive.

Tip to remember: Think of volatile chemicals that can explode or evaporate quickly. Volatile situations change suddenly.

Sentence: The stock market remained volatile after the announcement.